



national treasury

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National Treasury
REPUBLIC OF SOUTH AFRICA

SA-TIED

Southern Africa – Towards Inclusive Economic Development

News from the National Treasury Secure Data Facility

The National Treasury Secure Data Facility (NT-SDF) is pleased to introduce its latest dataset enhancements, including the refinement of data cleaning procedures to address minor inconsistencies and inefficiencies, along with the introduction of new variables to enhance specific datasets. The latest version of the datasets, version e5_v1, was released in the third quarter of 2023 and comes with a couple of adjustments. Firstly the dataset versioning system has been overhauled in an effort to be clearer and more precise. The previous method, which relied on extraction numbers¹ for versioning, sometimes led to confusion. This has been addressed by introducing a new, more intuitive format. Now, each dataset includes an extraction number, paired with a version number. The pairing eliminates any ambiguities. As an example, a new dataset from the fifth extraction is now labeled as e5-v1, clearly designating it as the inaugural version sourced from the fifth extraction of data.

Updated titles, files, and new additions

The dataset titles and file names have also been updated. Please note that this only applies to new or updated files; old versions file names are not renamed, as this would break too many dependencies. In annex 1 you will find details on the datasets that have been updated, and the three new datasets that have been added. The lists and the full names for the abbreviations are detailed in annex 2. Also included is a comprehensive readme file for each dataset, available on the server for use at the NT-SDF, to offer you more guidance and context.

Future developments

The data team is developing metadata for each dataset, which will be publicly available. Additionally, plans are underway to provide dummy datasets, enabling researchers to prepare code even when not at the NT-SDF. In 2024, NT-SDF will implement new processes and procedures to align with international best practices. A comprehensive data policy is under development and will be officially adopted upon completion. Please note that the lab will be closed during South African public holidays. Any additional downtimes for essential work will be communicated once dates are confirmed. We hope these enhanced resources will further support your research endeavours and look forward to keeping you updated on new developments.

¹ These extractions originate from the South African Revenue Service (SARS). In the previous versioning system, the version number corresponded to the extraction number. For example, datasets updated using the fourth extraction would be referred to as 'Version Four.'

Annex 1

Updated datasets			
Old name	New name	Period covered	Contents
cust_year_Imports/Exports_trans_v4 <i>cust_2015_Imports_v4</i>	ccd_year_Imports\Exports_e5_v1 <i>ccd_2015_Imports_e5_v1</i>	2009-2022	Customs Clearance Declarations: Import and export declarations from CCDs (i.e., SAD500 and CD1 forms).
cust_panel v4	ccdafp_2009_2022_e5_v1	2009-2023	Annualized import and export declarations from CCDs (i.e., SAD500 and CD1 forms).
vat_2015_cleaned_trans_v4	vatr_2015_e5_v1	2008-2022	VAT201 declarations that have been submitted by VAT vendors to SARS.
vat_panel_v4	vatafp_2008_2022_e5_v1	2008-2022	Annualized VAT201 declarations that have been submitted by VAT vendors to SARS. The data covers only corporate Income tax (CIT) submitting firms.
cit_panel_v4	citfp_2008_2022_e5_v1	2008-2022	Company data extracted from IT14/ITR14 forms.
irp5_panel_v4	eipcafp_2008_2022_e5_v1	2008-2022	Employment indicators based on weighting, employment measures, and nature of person status. Compiled from eipc-anu datasets.

citirp5_industry_v4	icfp_2008_2022_e5_v1	2008-2022	Industry classification variables from Budlender and Ebrahim's (2019) work.
citirp5_v4	stmfp_2008_2022_e5_v1	2008-2022	Firm-level matched panel formed by merging citfp, eipcafp, vatafp and ccdafp.
Individual panel	dips_2011_2022_e5_v1	2011-2022	Derived individual panel series composed of employment, IDs, income and source codes panels.
irp5_year_cleaned <i>irp5_2015_cleaned</i>	eipc_anu_year_e5_v1 <i>eipc_anu_2015_e5_v1</i>	2008-2021	Annual employee income payroll certificates.
New datasets			
Old name	New name	Period covered	Content
N/A	vatavp_2008_2022_e5_v1	2008-2022	Annualized VAT201 declarations that have been submitted by VAT vendors to SARS. The data covers all the VAT Vendors.

N/A	crs_2016_2022_e5_v1	2016-2022	Common reporting standards (CRS) of shared account information of residents from several jurisdictions.
N/A	pittr_year_e5_v1 <i>pittr_2016_e5_v1</i>	2014-2022	Unassessed personal income tax returns via the ITR12.

Note: Items in italics are example data file names

Annex 2

Data table names

Abbreviation	Full dataset name
ccd	Customs Clearance Declarations
ccdafp	Customs Clearance Declarations Annualized Firm Panel
vatr	Value Added Tax Returns
vatafp	Value Added Tax Annualized Firm Panel
citfp	Corporate Income Tax Firm Panel
eipcafp	Employee Income Payroll Certificate Annualized Firm Panel
icfp	Industry Classification Firm Panel
stmfp	SARS Treasury Matched Firm Panel
vatavp	Value Added Tax Annualized Vendor Panel
dips	Derived Individual Panel Series
eipc_int	Employee Income Payroll Certificate - Interim
eipc_anu	Employee Income Payroll Certificate - Annual
crs	Common Reporting Standards
pittr	Personal Income Tax Returns
pitar	Personal Income Tax Assessed Returns